different options emerged as various combinations of design and fabric types. Of these, four were shortlisted and adequate sample pieces were made into uniforms, which were then sent for trials to units all over India, in field areas and peace stations, from the deserts of Rajasthan to the jungles of the North East. Ultimately, one design was approved. I myself tested the new uniform during my visit to Eastern Command and that was the first time it was seen in public. It was formally introduced into the Army on Army Day 2022, with the SF contingent at the Army Day Parade wearing it for the first time. Most importantly, we also applied for the Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) of the design so as to be able to check its unauthorized manufacture and sale.[21]

One of the aspects that had been agitating Young Officers for a long time was what is called the 'lanyard' culture', the lanyard being a cord worn around the shoulder or neck with one end tucked into the breast pocket, which is taken out when required, to secure a whistle, knife or pistol. The lanyard now only had a ceremonial function, the requirement of securing such items having disappeared long ago, much like a vestigial organ. It can still be seen though, being used by the police to secure the pistol on their hip. Like everything else, it had its utility at some point in time, but for the Army, it had lost its functional value. Every Infantry Regiment and Corps (Armoured, Artillery, Signal, Medical, etc.) has its own set of accoutrements of different colours and patterns, though all are worn on the basic olive-green uniform. Of all the accoutrements, the lanyard is the most distinctive.

Each Regiment and Corps gets associated with a particular colour, which permeates into the consciousness of every soldier of that Regiment and is one of the factors that goes towards inculcating esprit de corps. For the Sikh Light Infantry, it is

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